CASE STUDY: GETTING STARTED WITH ZOHO CREATOR — ACCOUNT SETUP AND BUILDING A FORM-BASED APPLICATION

1. Aim

To understand the process of setting up an account in Zoho Creator and developing a simple form-based application using its low-code application development environment.

2. Objectives

- To understand the basic features and purpose of Zoho Creator.
- To learn how to create an account and access the application development platform.
- To design and create forms for collecting and storing data.
- To understand how to add fields, configure field types, and enter sample records.
- To explore how a form-based application simplifies data collection and management.

3. Introduction

Zoho Creator is a low-code application development platform that enables users to build business applications with minimal manual coding. It provides a visual development environment in which users can create forms, reports, workflows, and dashboards to manage business information.

Form-based applications are commonly used to collect structured data such as employee details, student records, customer information, inventory details, and maintenance requests. Instead of maintaining separate paper records or spreadsheets, users can store and manage information through a centralized application.

This case study demonstrates how to get started with Zoho Creator by setting up an account and building a simple **Student Information Management System**.

4. Problem Statement

Many educational institutions maintain student information using paper forms or spreadsheets. These methods can lead to duplicate entries, difficulty in searching records, data-entry errors, and delays in updating information.

A simple digital application is required to collect, store, and retrieve student details efficiently. Developing a form-based application using Zoho Creator provides a practical way to organize student records without requiring extensive programming knowledge.

5. Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is to create a Student Information Management System using Zoho Creator. The application contains a form that allows users to enter student details and store them as records.

5.1 Account Setup

1. Open a web browser and visit the official Zoho Creator website: https://www.zoho.com/creator/.
2. Select the option to sign up or start using the platform.
3. Register using the available account creation method and complete any required verification.
4. Sign in to Zoho Creator.
5. Open the application workspace and choose the available option to create a new application.

Note: The available sign-up options and interface labels may vary depending on the account and current platform version.

5.2 Creating a New Application

1. Select the option to create a new application.
2. Choose a suitable starting method, such as creating an application from scratch, if available.
3. Enter the application name as **Student Information Management System**.

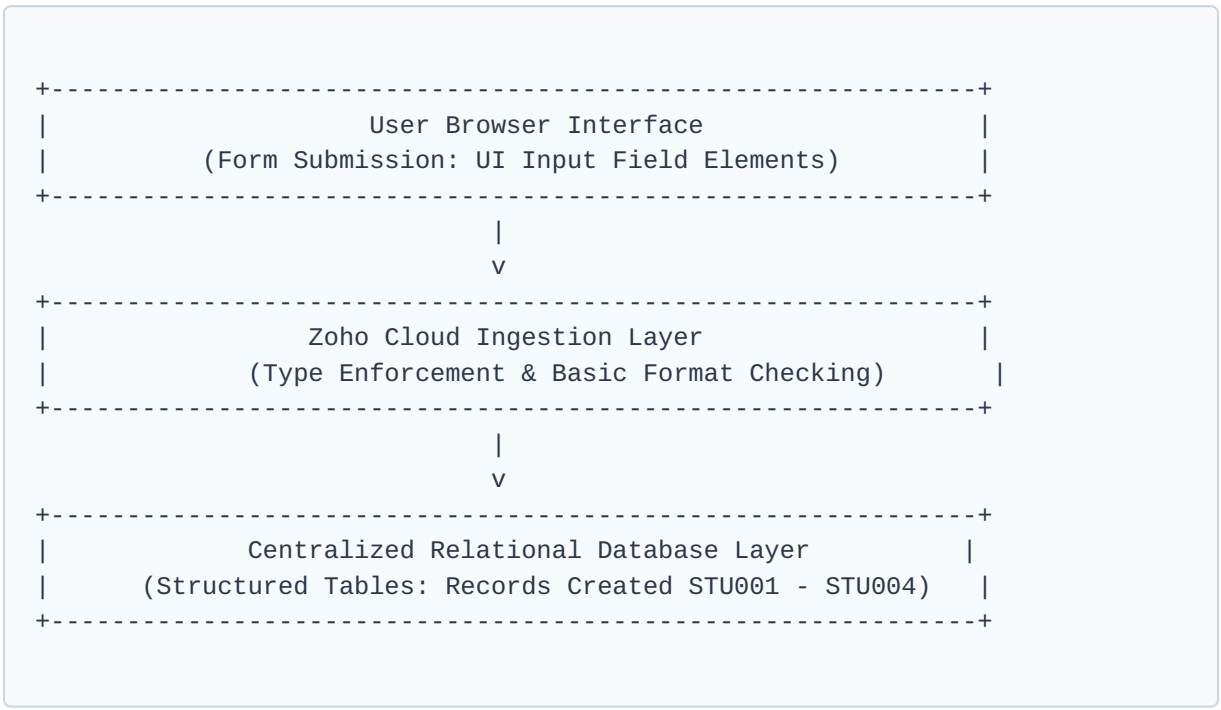
4. Confirm the creation of the application.
5. Open the application builder to begin designing the form.

5.3 Designing the Student Form

Create a form named **Student Details** and add the following fields:

Field Name	Field Type	Purpose
Student ID	Single Line	Stores the student's identification number
Student Name	Single Line	Stores the student's full name
Department	Dropdown	Selects the student's department (Computer Science, Electronics, Mechanical, Information Technology)
Year of Study	Dropdown	Records the current academic year (First Year, Second Year, Third Year, Fourth Year)
Phone Number	Phone	Stores contact information
Email Address	Email	Stores the student's email address
Date of Admission	Date	Records the admission date

Data Ingestion Flow Architecture



5.4 Adding Sample Records

After creating the form, open its live or preview mode and enter sample student information.

Student ID	Student Name	Department	Year of Study
STU001	Arun Kumar	Computer Science	First Year
STU002	Priya S	Electronics	Second Year
STU003	Kavin R	Mechanical	Third Year
STU004	Divya M	Information Technology	First Year

5.5 Testing the Application

Test the application by performing the following activities:

- Add a new student record.
- Check whether the submitted details appear in the stored records or report view.

- Verify that dropdown fields display the configured choices.
- Check whether required fields and field types behave as configured.
- Correct or update a record if editing is enabled.
- Confirm that the form is accessible to the intended users under the application's permissions.

6. Functional Features

- **Data entry:** Users can enter student information through a structured form.
- **Data storage:** Submitted information is stored as application records.
- **Data organization:** Fields keep student details in a consistent format.
- **Record retrieval:** Users can view and locate saved information through the available report or list view.
- **Reduced manual work:** Digital records reduce dependence on paper forms and repeated spreadsheet entry.
- **Future expansion:** Additional features, such as attendance tracking, department-wise reports, and notifications, can be added as requirements grow.

7. Results and Benefits

1. Faster collection and organization of student details.
2. Reduced paperwork and easier record retrieval.
3. More consistent data entry through predefined field types.
4. Easier updating and maintenance of records.
5. A simple development process that requires little or no manual coding for the basic form.

8. Limitations

The basic application stores student details but does not automatically provide advanced functions such as attendance management, fee tracking, or automated notifications unless they are separately configured. The application also requires internet access for normal cloud-based use, and access permissions should be set appropriately to protect student information.

9. Conclusion

This case study demonstrates how Zoho Creator can be used to set up an account and develop a basic form-based application. By creating the Student Information Management System, the process of designing forms, defining fields, entering sample records, and testing stored data is illustrated.